Evan Kiess

Chapel Hill, NC 27516
(252) 916-9097 | ekiess@unc.edu | ekiess.com

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill & NC State University **Anticipated May 2027**
B.S., Biomedical Engineering, GPA: 3.6
Minor, Hispanic Studies

PROJECTS

MRI-Compatible Mouse VR Goggles **Dec 2025 - Present**

- SURF project developing fMRI-compatible virtual reality goggles for mice
- Continuing this research as the topic of my undergraduate honors thesis

Robotic Putter **May 2026 - Aug 2026**

- Designed and built a fully-custom robotic golf putter that compensates for tremors

Tiny Tuner **May 2025 - Jul 2025**

- Developed a compact guitar tuner with ESP32 microcontroller and MEMS microphone
- Implemented FFT and YIN algorithm in Arduino framework for pitch detection

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research and Development Engineer **Jul 2026 - Present**
SONARA, Chapel Hill, NC

- Design and fabricate prototypes for an early-stage medtech startup

Research Assistant **Dec 2025 - Present**
Center for Animal MRI, Chapel Hill, NC

- Design and fabricate novel fixtures for fMRI brain scans of awake mice

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant **Aug 2025 - Dec 2025**
Lampe Joint Department of BME

- Supported students enrolled in BMME 207: Biomedical Electronics

Research Assistant **Jan 2025 - Aug 2025**
Coherence Imaging Laboratory, Chapel Hill, NC

- Participated in novel OCT imaging research on PFAS effects on mammary cells
- Implemented several noise-reduction and signal analysis algorithms in MATLAB

Calculus Teaching Assistant **Aug 2022 - May 2023**
North Carolina School of Science and Math, Durham, NC

- Tutored calculus students in 1-on-1 and group settings
- Created and adapted lesson plans to fit students' individual needs

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

RAM Robotics - *Project Lead* **Jan 2025 - May 2026**

- Lead a project to design and fabricate a basketball-shooting robot
- Developed a smart trash can using computer vision to increase recycling compliance

Well Woven Youth - *Director of Operations* **Sep 2025 - Present**

- Organized fundraising events and orchestrated oral hygiene drives

Carolina Adapts Toys for Children (CATCH) - *Member* **Aug 2023 - Present**

- Modify children's toys to increase accessibility for children with disabilities

UNC iGEM Competition Team - *Website Developer* **Jan 2024 - Jul 2024**

- Participate in revolutionary PFAS research
- Synthesize dense, technical research into easily digestible information

SKILLS & RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Technical: Mechanical design, independent research, electronics/PCB design, embedded systems design
Professional: Time management, teamwork, leadership, communication, and organization
Coursework: Differential Equations, Discrete Mathematics, Solid Mechanics, Brain Machine Interfaces
Languages: Fluent in Spanish